

February

7



1959

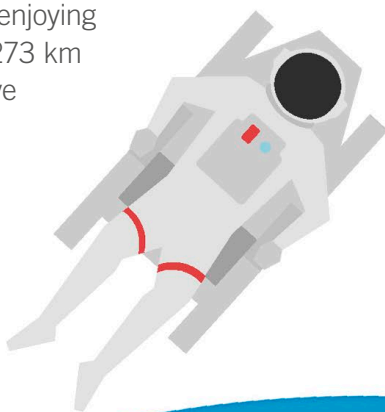
Record flight

A flight endurance world record was set when two young pilots, Robert Timm and John Cook, flew an aircraft over the Great Basin Desert in Nevada, USA, for 64 days, 22 hours, and 19 minutes without stopping. Their plane was refuelled in the air.

Walking in space

US astronaut Bruce McCandless performed the first untethered spacewalk when he left NASA's Space Shuttle *Challenger* in Earth's orbit and moved freely for 90 minutes, enjoying the views from 273 km (170 miles) above the planet.

1984



Born this day

1978 Omotola Jalade Ekeinde, Nigerian actor, singer, business leader, and activist. She has featured in around 300 Nollywood films.

1979 Tawakkol Karman, Yemeni human rights activist. She received the Nobel Peace Prize in 2011 for her leading role in a pro-democracy protest movement.

Smashed to pieces

The ancient Roman Portland Vase, which dates back to the 1st century BCE, was broken by a visitor to the British Museum in an act of vandalism. In the late 1980s, the glass vase was restored to its original state.

1845



Also on this day

1992 The Maastricht Treaty was signed by 12 western European nations, laying the foundations for the European Union (EU).

2008 South African Ram Barkai set a record by swimming in the most southerly part of the world – off Antarctica's Queen Maud Land.

2014 Scientists dated the Happisburgh footprints of Norfolk, UK, to be at least 800,000 years old – the oldest outside Africa.